

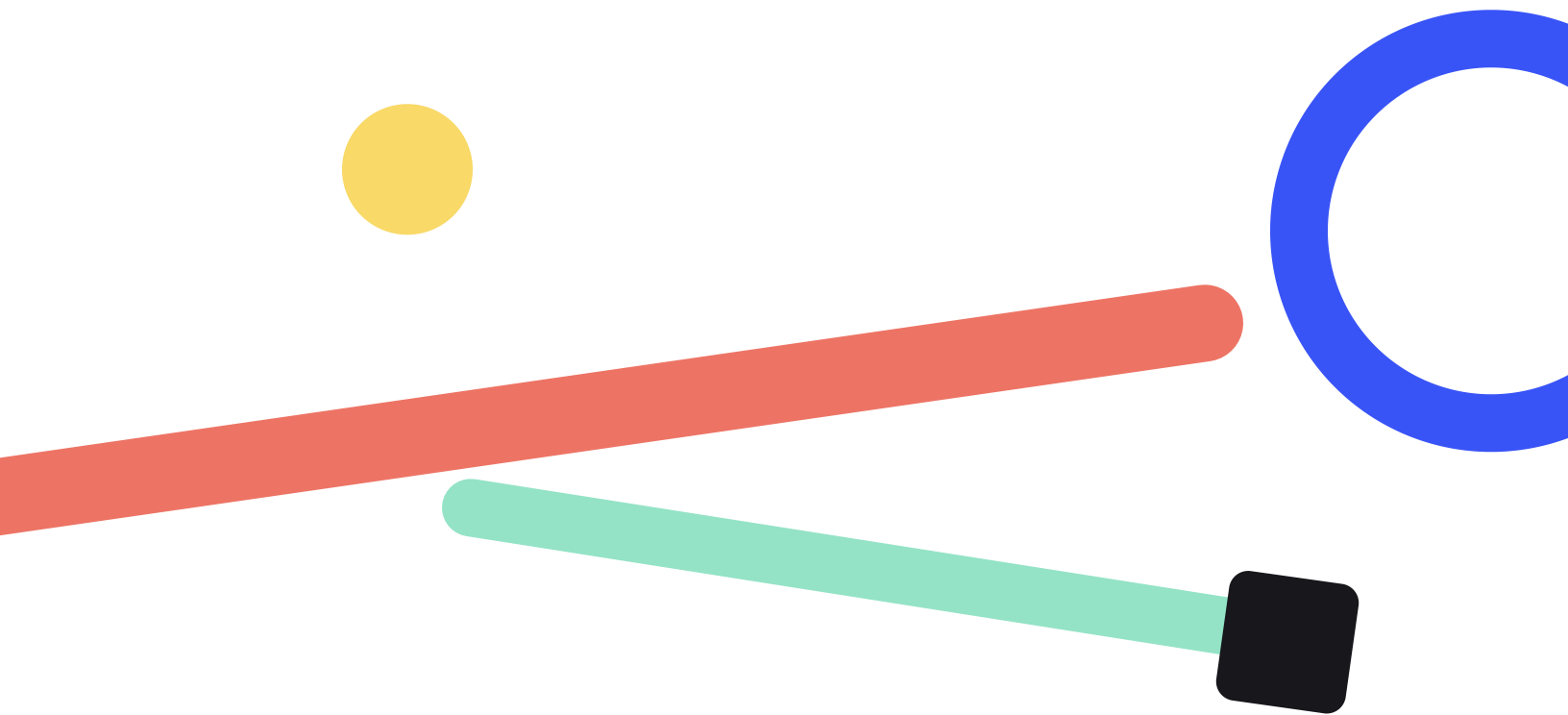
VOLUME 05: THE LOOKBACK

Audience Voices

From research to the real world, January to October 2026.

How the audience research was put to work through search, social, email and SMS: what we published, what people read, what reached them, and what to fix next.

October 2026



RESEARCH IN PRACTICE



About this entry: how the research was put to work

What this is. The fifth entry in the Audience Voices series looks back at how the audience research shaped what the firm actually published and sent between January 1 and October 9, 2026: blogs and search, social media, and email and SMS.

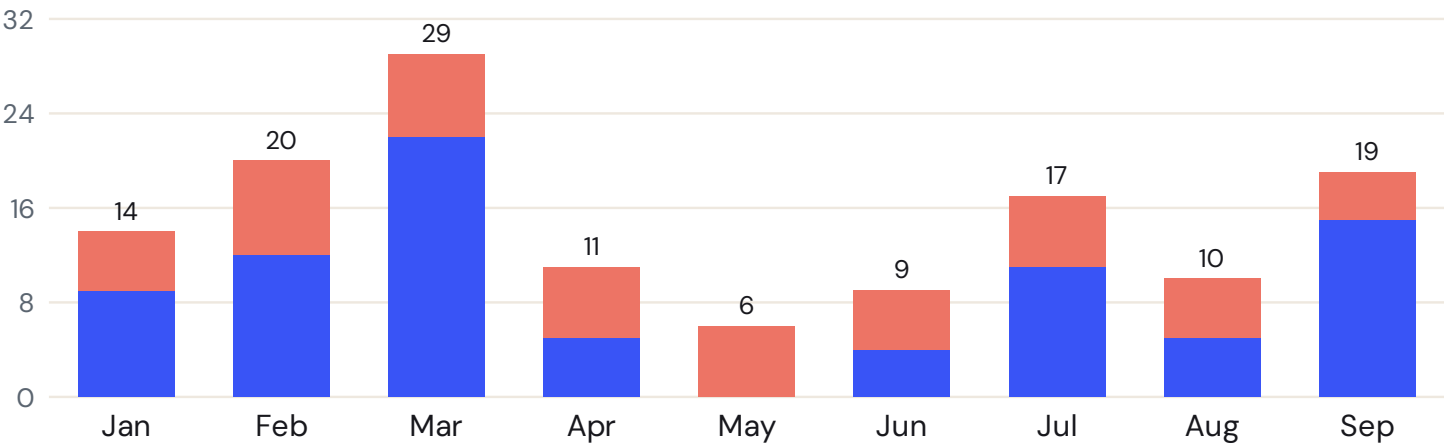
How it was built. Every count comes from the firm's own systems: the Asana Blog Shelf and Content Bank, Google Analytics 4, Sprout Social and GoHighLevel. Each finding is set against the five decisions the research recommended.

Source	What it gave us	Status
Asana Blog Shelf	136 posts published Dec 31, 2025 to Sep 30, 2026, with author, site, keywords and distribution flags	Complete
Asana Content Bank	The three content pillars, their backlog and the 99 most recent executed cards (Aug 16 to Oct 9)	Complete
Google Analytics 4	Views, sessions, key events and engagement for the top 300 pages; channels by month; source and medium	Complete
Sprout Social	Profile, post, paid, competitor and review reports, Nov 3, 2025 to Oct 9, 2026, against the year before	Complete
GoHighLevel	Every audience email and workflow step, Dec 31, 2025 to Oct 8, 2026	Complete
Search Console	Pages through GA4 (May 2025 to Oct 2026) and a query export (Apr 2025 to Aug 2026)	Complete
Backlinks audit	666 links from 527 domains, each marked keep, review or disavow	Complete

Year-over-year social figures compare November 3, 2025 to October 9, 2026 with the same-length period before it.

The lookback at a glance

Figure 1 Blog posts published each month in 2026. Blue: written in-house. Coral: written by the content vendor.



Measure	Result
Blog posts published	136 (84 in-house, 52 by the vendor)
Posts that reached the site's top 300 pages	76 of 136, with 9,454 views between them
Most-read 2026 post	What Happens If Southstate Gets Rid of Inspection Stickers? (1,339 views)
Content Bank cards executed, Aug 16 to Oct 9	99 (37 internal research briefs, 62 published or sent pieces)
Organic Google clicks a month	452 before the survey, 832 in January to May 2026, 528 since June
Social impressions and posts (Sprout)	4.47 million impressions from 1,275 posts, reach flat on 58% fewer posts
Paid social web conversions	99, up from 22, on a flat budget
Audience emails sent (GoHighLevel)	23,240, with a 2.3% click rate; community emails drew up to 7.4%

What the research asked for, and where we looked

Research decision	What putting it to work looks like	Where we checked
1. Lead with answers	Practical Next Steps content on every channel	Blog Shelf pillars; GA4 views; Content Bank formats
2. Add everyday stories	Life After a Crash stories for broad story viewers	Blog Shelf pillars; client review and story posts
3. Stay close to home	Capital City and Riverside County places, local news style, community	Local keywords; community site; quizzes and events in GA4
4. One message, Facebook first	Same assets everywhere; Facebook as main distribution	Meta flags; channel tags; GA4 social sources; Social Planner
5. Test, and judge by outcomes	Tagged links; actions such as clicks and submissions as the measure	UTM audit in GA4; key events; paid conversions

How to read this entry. Parts 1 to 3 show what was done on each channel. The full verdict on each claim is in Part 4 (p. 37).

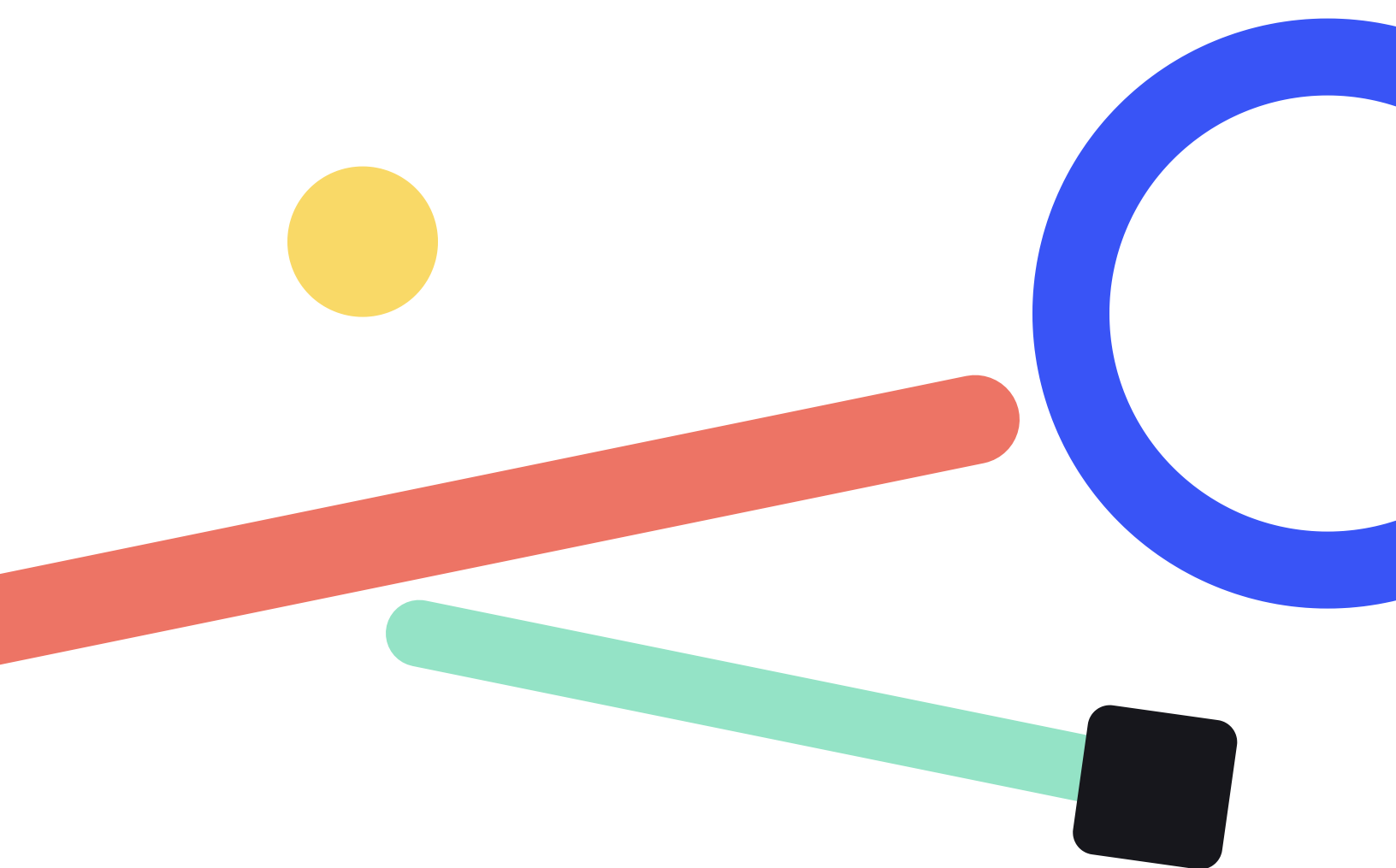
PART 1, WHAT THE BLOG DID

Search and the website

**See what the blog produced, which pillars it served,
and what the traffic says.**

Start with [What we published](#) (p. **6**). The money-page story runs from [Money pages](#) (p. **11**) to [Backlinks](#) (p. **15**).

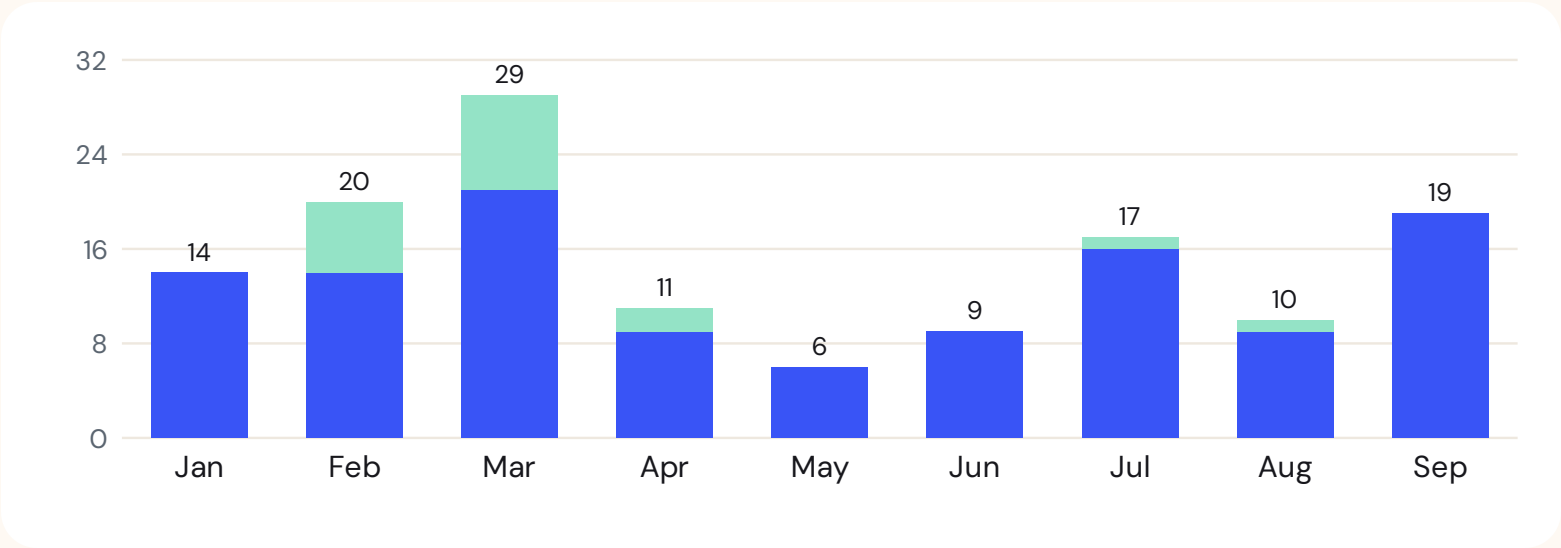
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WHAT THE BLOG DID

What we published: who wrote it and where

Figure 2 Posts by site each month. Blue: the main website. Mint: The community site.



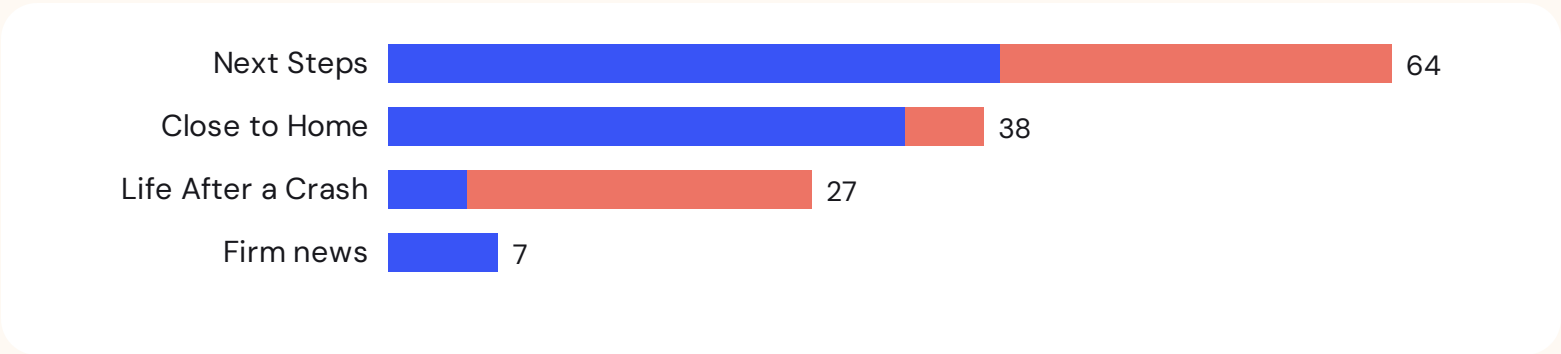
Two engines. The strategist wrote 84 posts and the content vendor wrote 52. In-house output peaked in March (22 posts), stopped in May, and returned in July and September; the vendor published a steady four to eight posts a month.

The community site paused. Eighteen posts went to the community site, sixteen of them between February and April: faith reflections, Bingo Night and local guides. After April it carried only two firm stories, until news-format posts resumed in October.

Counts come from the Asana Blog Shelf; one republished post (The Deadliest Road Stretches) is counted once.

Which pillars the blogs served

Figure 3 Posts by research pillar and author. Each bar shows one pillar; blue is in-house, coral is the vendor.



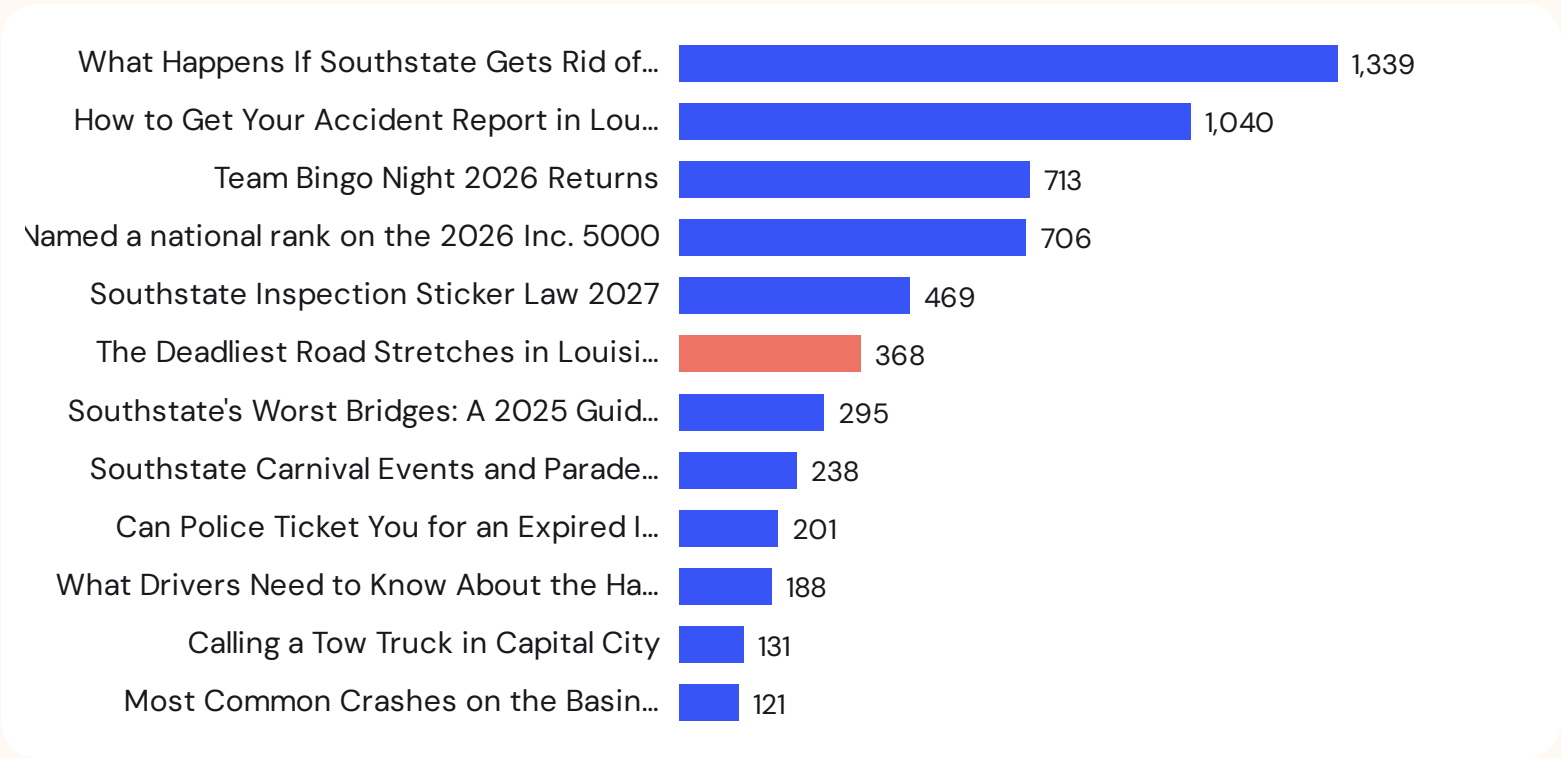
Answers dominate. 64 of 136 posts are Next Steps answers, the pillar the research said suits everyone.

A division of labor appeared. In-house posts carried almost all the Close to Home work (33 of 38) and named a local place 44% of the time. Vendor posts named a local place 13% of the time and wrote 22 of the 27 Life After a Crash posts, mostly wrongful-death and brain-injury legal explainers rather than everyday stories.

Pillars assigned from each title and its keywords; the rules are in Methods (p. 45). Content Bank’s own buckets map closely: 99 posts fit Car Accident Victims Advocacy, 24 Local Community First and 13 Best Personal Injury Law Firm.

Top blogs: the 2026 posts people actually read

Figure 4 Most-viewed 2026 posts, January 1 to October 9. GA4 views. Coral marks vendor posts.



What wins. Law changes that touch every driver. Three inspection–sticker posts drew 2,009 views between them, and the 2027 law post held readers longest (about 79 seconds of engagement per view). The accident–report guide and Inc. 5000 news round out the top four.

What it means. The audience reads Next Steps answers about rules that affect their own car, written for Southstate. That is the research's first and third decisions working together.

What the traffic says by pillar and author

Pillar	Posts published	Posts in top 300	Views (top 300 posts)	Median views
Next Steps	64	40	5,331	58
Close to Home	38	18	2,547	59
Life After a Crash	27	15	776	45
Firm news	7	3	800	50

Author	Posts published	Posts in top 300	Views	Median views
In-house	84	50	7,868	60
Vendor	52	26	1,586	48

In-house posts carry the traffic. Sixty percent of in-house posts reached the top 300 pages against half of vendor posts, and in-house posts drew five times the views.

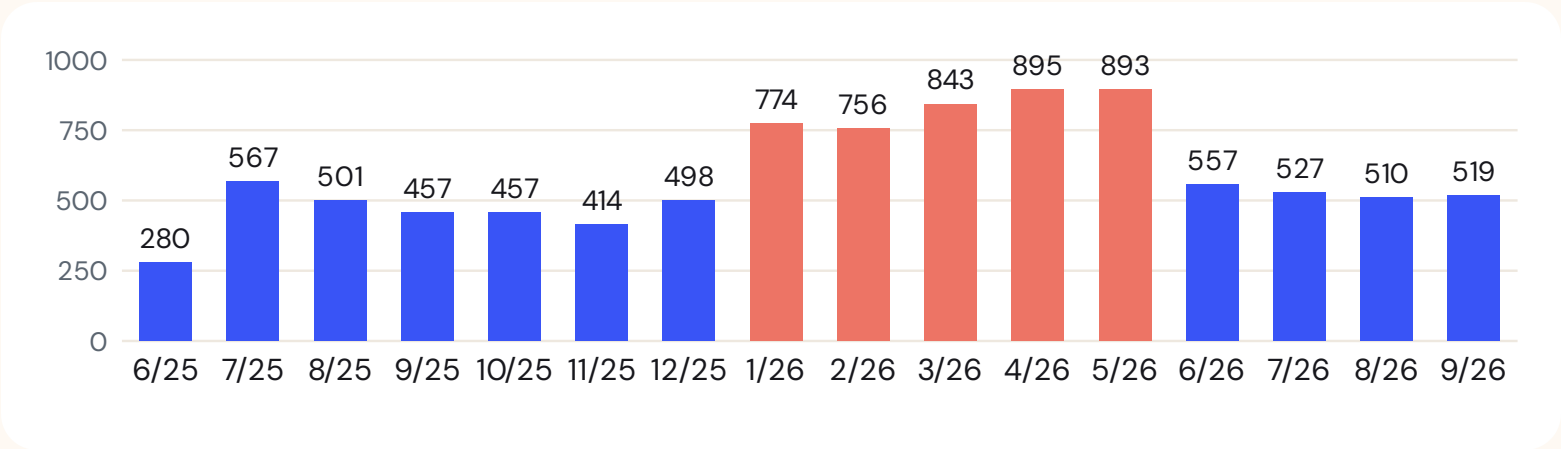
Close to Home outperforms its size. Local pages beyond the blog prove the point: the Capital City and Riverside County quizzes drew 1,592 views and the Bingo Night pages about 3,400.

Stories underperform. Life After a Crash posts have the lowest median (45 views). As written, they are legal explainers, not the everyday stories the research called for.

Posts outside the top 300 pages had fewer than 38 views each in the period.

Search since the survey: rankings climbed, then slipped

Figure 5 Organic Google clicks per month, June 2025 to September 2026. Search Console data through GA4.



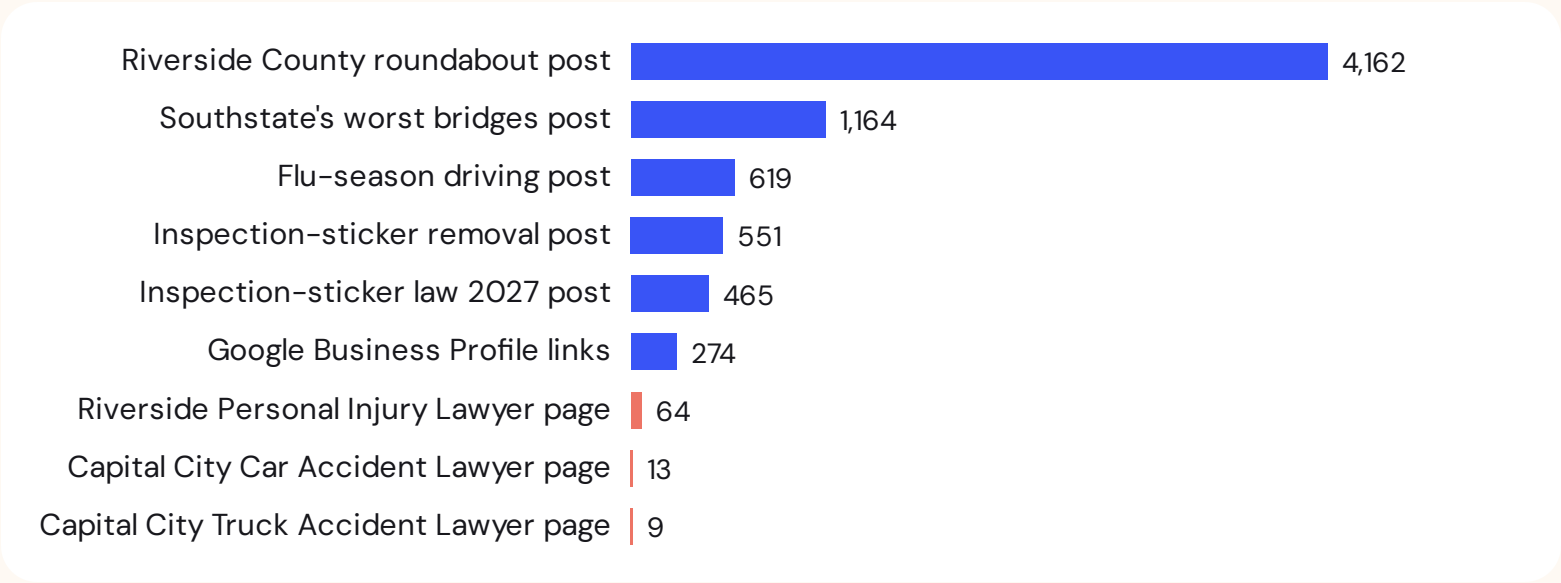
Window	Impressions a month	Clicks a month	Average position
June to October 2025	221,505	452	19.4
January to May 2026	282,846	832	11.9
June to September 2026	179,414	528	14.3

What it shows. After the survey the site climbed about seven places in average position and organic clicks rose 84%, peaking from January to May (coral). From June both slipped: impressions fell 37% and clicks 37%, the same dip GA4 shows in organic sessions.

Average position is weighted by impressions. Search Console data for this property begins in May 2025.

Money pages: seen 724,000 times, clicked 77 times

Figure 6 Organic clicks per 100,000 impressions, 2026. Coral: the commercial pages.



Page and window	Impressions	Clicks	Average position
Car accident page, Jun to Oct 2025	334,591	29	11.9
Car accident page, Jan to May 2026	262,699	34	8.6
Car accident page, Jun to Oct 2026	108,122	13	about 10.9
Truck accident page, Jun to Oct 2025	170,966	17	16.0
Truck accident page, Jan to May 2026	211,647	20	6.6
Truck accident page, Jun to Oct 2026	141,500	10	about 7.6

Ranked but not chosen. Both money pages climbed onto page one in spring 2026, yet Google sends them about one click per 10,000 appearances. The car accident page drew 18,953 sessions this year and converts well, but organic search supplied 47; paid search supplies the rest.

June to October 2026 figures are the full year less January to May; positions for that window are estimated. Query-level data needs a direct Search Console export.

Where organic search clicks actually come from

Figure 7 Organic Google clicks by page, January 1 to October 8, 2026. Coral: the commercial pages.



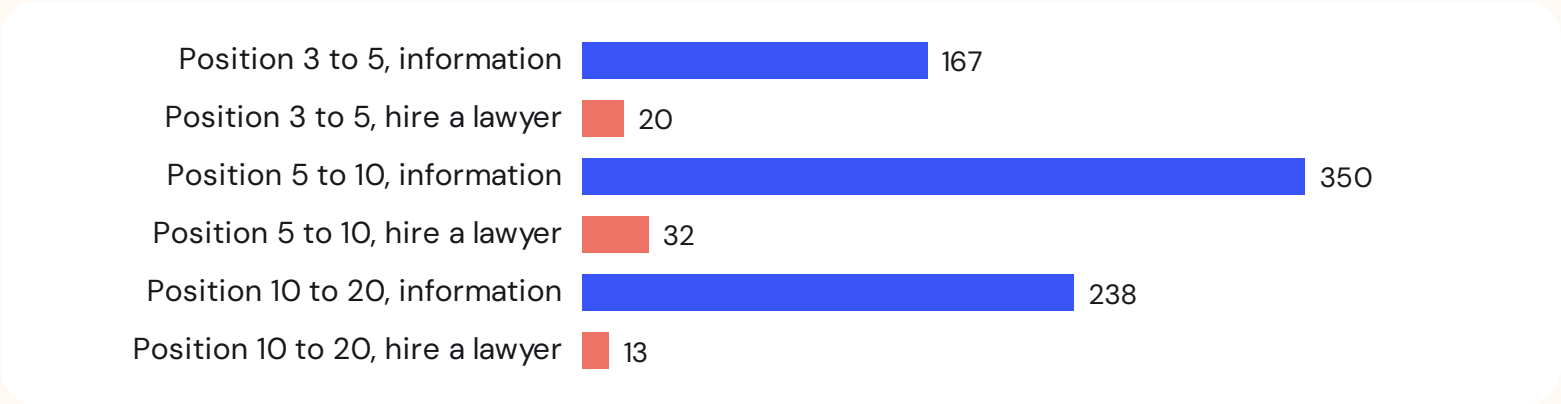
Answers and local posts carry organic search. Five Next Steps and Close to Home posts drew 1,571 organic clicks, twenty times the two money pages combined.

People pages pull searchers too. The Our Team page (367 clicks) and attorney bios (153, 74 and 53 clicks) outdraw the commercial pages, the same people-first pattern seen on social.

Brand searches carry the profile. Google Business Profile links drew 319 clicks, mostly from people searching the firm's name. On hire-a-lawyer searches they drew almost none (Many doors, p. 14).

Why the money pages are seen but not chosen: the query view

Figure 8 Clicks per 100,000 impressions by ranking position: hire-a-lawyer searches against information searches.
Coral: hire-a-lawyer searches. April 2025 to August 2026, top 1,000 queries.



Search type	Impressions	Clicks	Click rate
Hire-a-lawyer searches (308 queries)	1,233,962	263	0.02%
Brand searches (firm, founder and attorney names)	21,605	2,218	10.3%
Legal and accident information	70,163	129	0.18%

What it shows. Hire-a-lawyer searches are three quarters of the firm's search visibility and 8% of its clicks. At the same positions, information searches are clicked ten times as often. Brand searches, 1% of impressions, bring 70% of clicks.

Source: Search Console export, April 24, 2025 to August 24, 2026, with the workbook's own intent and brand labels. Desktop carries 67% of impressions at a 0.17% click rate against 0.39% on mobile, a sign that automated rank checks may inflate commercial impressions; even so, the gap with information searches holds.



Many doors, no front door: pages competing for the same search

Ranking URL for "car accident lawyer"	Impressions	Clicks	Position
Capital City Car Accident Lawyer page	22,231	5	6.8
Home page	9,192	0	1.9
Home page via Google Business Profile link	7,194	0	1.1
Blog: how to find the best car accident lawyer	6,551	0	21.0
Riverside page via Google Business Profile link	2,021	0	1.7
Southstate Car Accident Attorney page	1,422	0	19.7

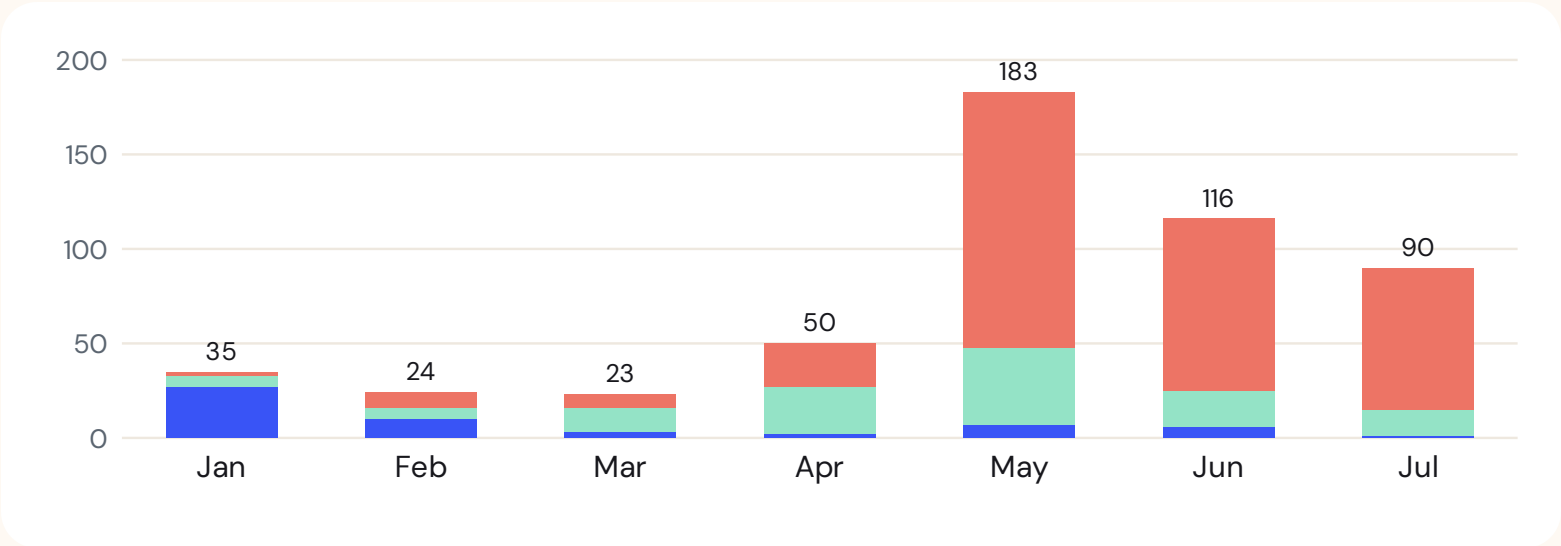
URL type across the 13 priority searches	Impressions	Clicks	Click rate
Commercial pages	207,334	70	0.03%
Home page	78,158	6	0.01%
Google Business Profile links (average position 2)	22,743	2	0.01%
Blog posts	4,381	0	0%

What it shows. Every one of the 13 priority hire-a-lawyer searches has several firm URLs ranking at once: the money page, the home page, profile-listing links, the Riverside page and blog posts. Google splits the signal, and none becomes the clear answer.

A correction. The Business Profile links that sit near the top of these searches drew 2 clicks in 22,743 appearances. Their 319 clicks this year come mostly from people searching the firm's name; the profile wins the branded click, not the hire-a-lawyer click.

Backlinks: authority sits on the home page, and spam arrived in spring

Figure 9 Backlinks by month first seen and audit decision, January to July 2026. Blue: keep. Mint: review. Coral: disavow.



Target	Backlinks	Keep	Review	Disavow
Home page	467	19	98	350
Capital City Car Accident Lawyer	12	6	6	0
Capital City Truck Accident Lawyer	2	0	2	0
Southstate Car Accident Attorney	0	0	0	0
Blog and other pages	185	70	110	5

What it shows. Of 666 backlinks, 95 are worth keeping and 355 should be disavowed; 324 of those spam links appeared from April to July 2026, when organic clicks and rankings slipped. The timing matches; the audit cannot prove cause. The money pages have almost no links of their own, while answer posts earned the best ones: local radio and news sites citing the Southstate DUI law post.

Source: backlinks audit, 666 links from 527 domains.



Search: what to do next

Move	Why
Give each money search one front door	All 13 priority searches split across several firm URLs; point internal links, titles and the Business Profile at one page per search
Disavow the spring spam wave	355 spam links, 324 of them first seen April to July 2026; file the audit's disavow list and watch whether rankings recover
Earn links for the money pages	The car accident page has 6 keepable links, the truck page none; send directory listings, sponsorships and press mentions to them
Turn answer posts into link magnets	Radio and news sites linked to the DUI law post; pitch law-change explainers to local media
Rewrite money-page titles and descriptions	Hire-a-lawyer searches convert at 0.02% even on page one
Grow brand demand	Brand searches bring 70% of organic clicks at a 10% click rate; social, community and email build those searches
Keep the answer clusters coming	Information searches are clicked ten times as often as hire searches at the same position



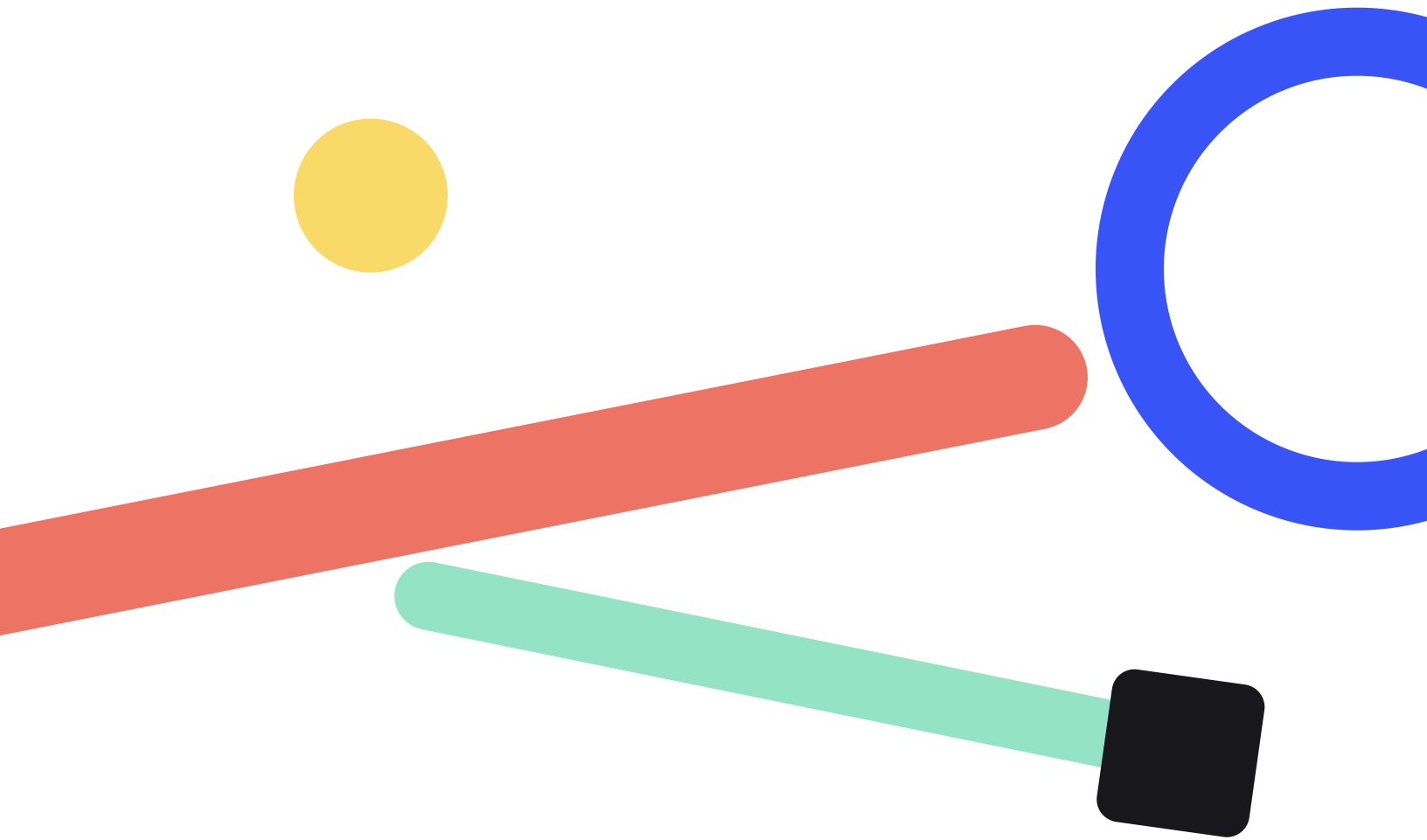
PART 2, WHAT REACHED PEOPLE

Social media

See how content reached social, what the Content Bank shipped, and what the traffic and tags show.

Start with [Social, year over year](#) (p. 18). Competitors and paid social follow in [Benchmark](#) (p. 24) and [Paid social](#) (p. 26).

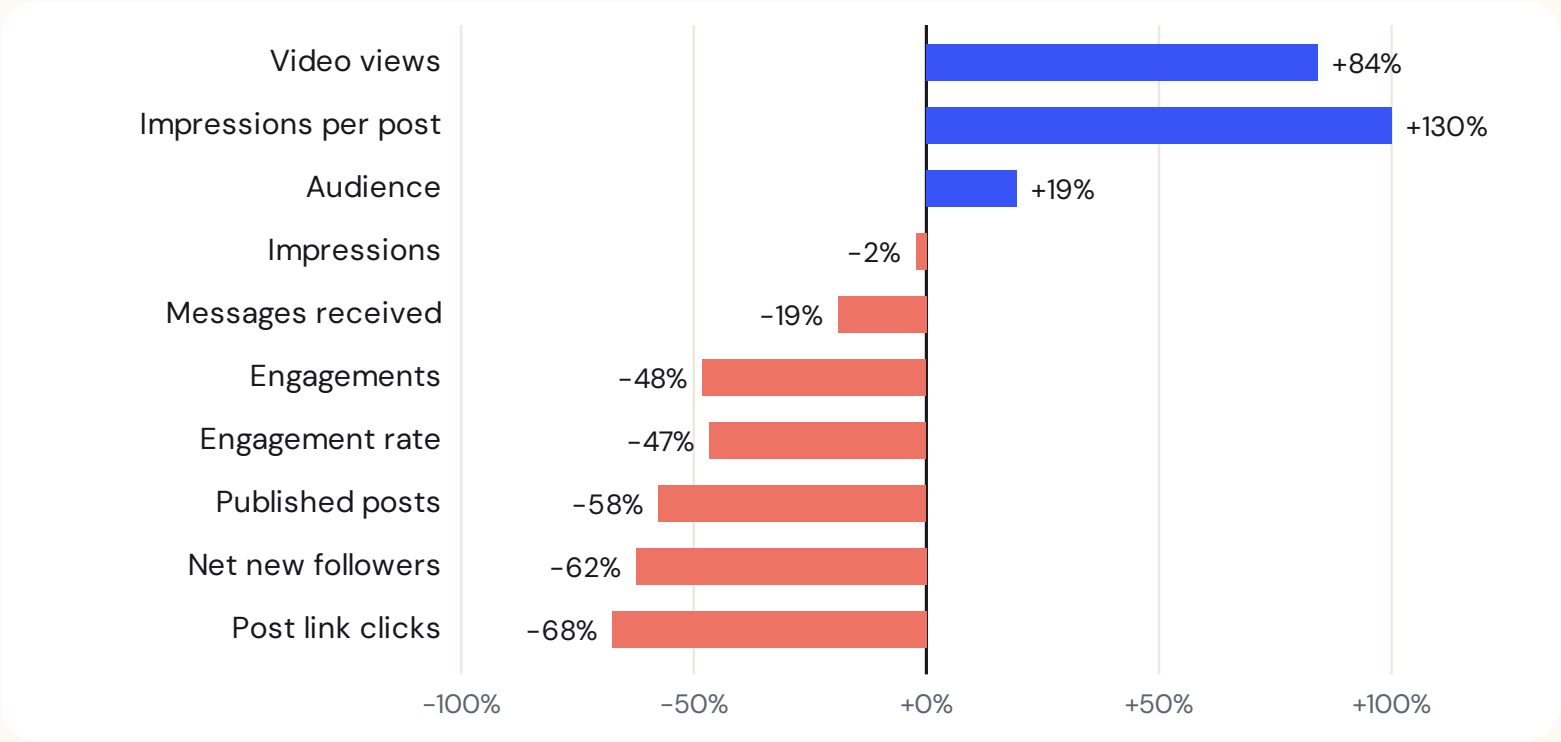
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WHAT REACHED PEOPLE

Social, year over year: fewer posts, the same reach, half the engagement

Figure 10 Change against the same-length year before, November 3, 2025 to October 9, 2026. Blue: up. Coral: down. Sprout Social, all firm profiles.



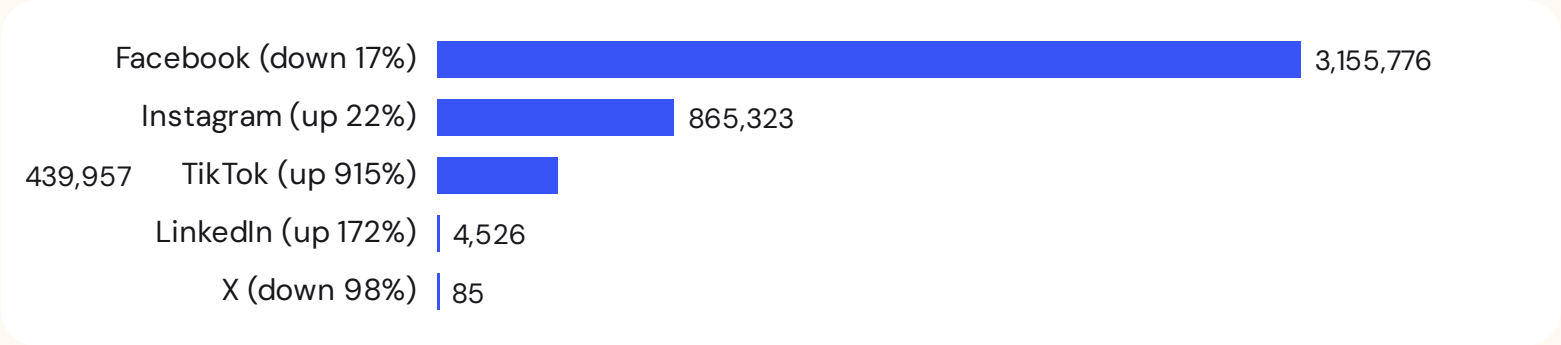
Measure	Year before	This year
Published posts	3,008	1,275
Impressions	4,569,153	4,465,667
Impressions per post	1,519	3,502
Engagements	108,186	56,124
Post link clicks	about 28,300	9,206
Video views	about 382,000	703,192
Audience	5,884	7,028

What it shows. The firm posted less than half as often and kept the same reach, so each post reached more than twice as many people. Engagement, link clicks and new followers fell by half or more.



By network: Facebook carries the reach, Instagram and TikTok went quiet

Figure 11 Impressions or views by network this year. Change against the year before in brackets.



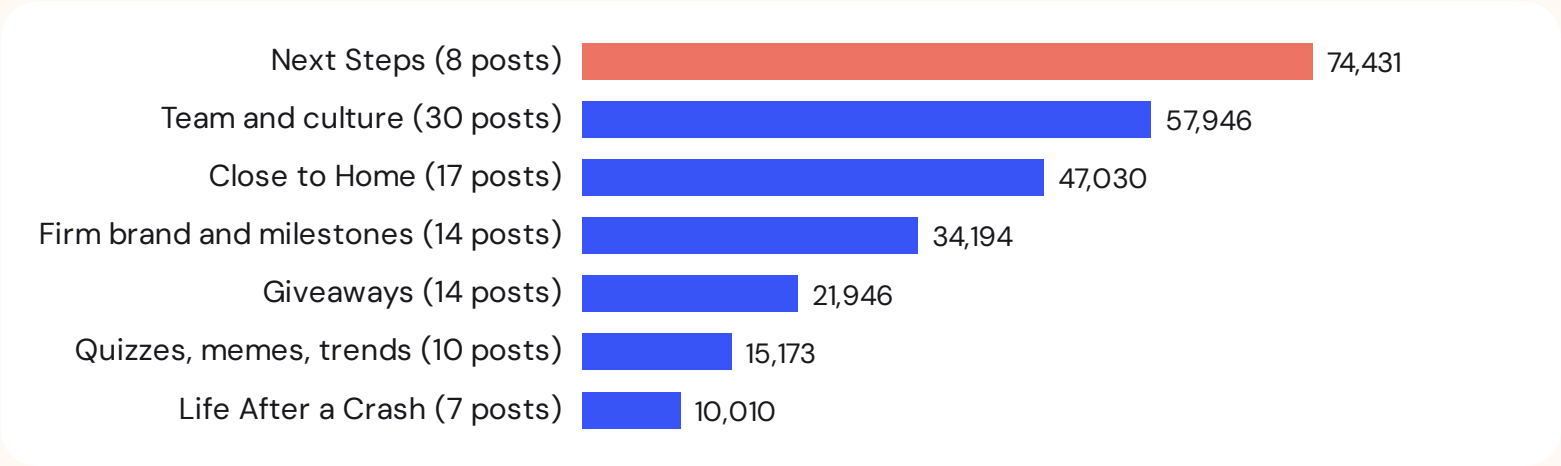
Network	Engagements	Change	Engagement rate
Facebook	54,493	down 46%	1.7%
Instagram	1,044	down 81%	0.1%
LinkedIn	238	up 83%	5.3%
TikTok	234	down 84%	0.1%
YouTube	115	down 88%	n/a

Facebook is the engine. It delivered 71% of impressions and 97% of engagements, matching the survey finding that Facebook is where this audience already is.

Check the Instagram and TikTok connections. Their impressions and engagement lines stop after May 2026 in Sprout. Either posting stopped or the profiles disconnected from Sprout; both cut the second-platform role the research recommended.

What content earned the most views on social

Figure 12 The 100 most-viewed posts this year, total views by content type. Each post at least 1,063 views.



Most-viewed posts	Views
Your inspection sticker is changing — mark your calendar for J...	43,468
Southstate lawmakers are talking about doing away with inspecti...	17,699
Our goal was simple. We wanted to create an evening filled wit...	8,917
The Basin Bridge stretches about 18 miles above th...	7,958
Most Southstate drivers have had a brake tag on their windshiel...	6,341
Big welcome to [name], our new 5-star Litigation Paralegal!...	6,326

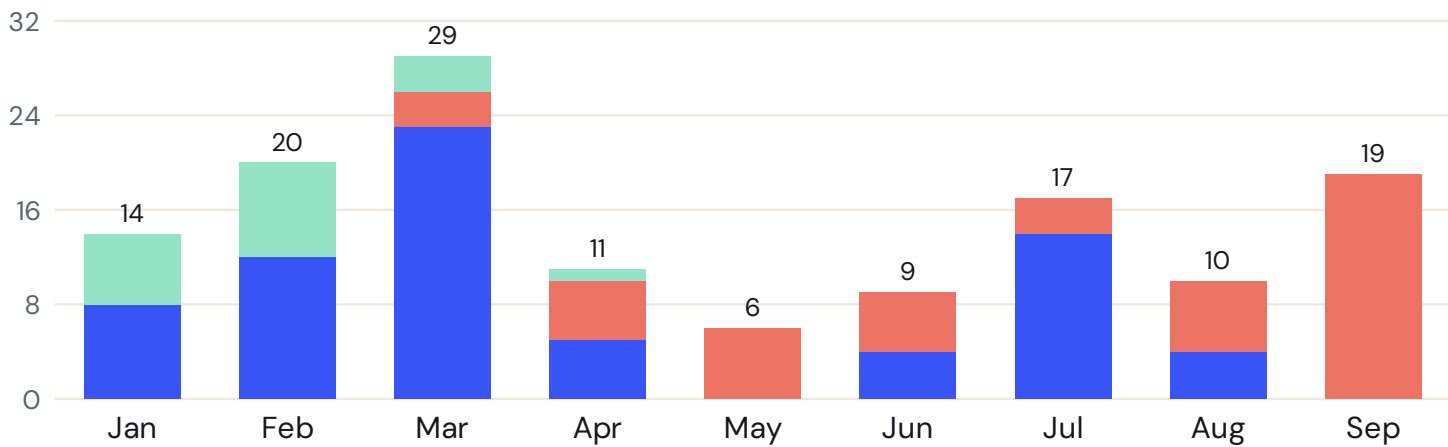
Next Steps wins again. Eight practical posts drew the most views; the three inspection-sticker posts alone drew 67,508. The same topic led the blog, so one answer worked on both channels.

Team posts fill the list. Thirty of the top 100 are birthdays, anniversaries and new hires. They draw steady views from people who know the team; Life After a Crash stories drew the fewest.



How blogs reached social

Figure 13 Blog posts flagged as posted to Meta, by month. Blue: posted. Coral: not posted. Mint: not recorded.



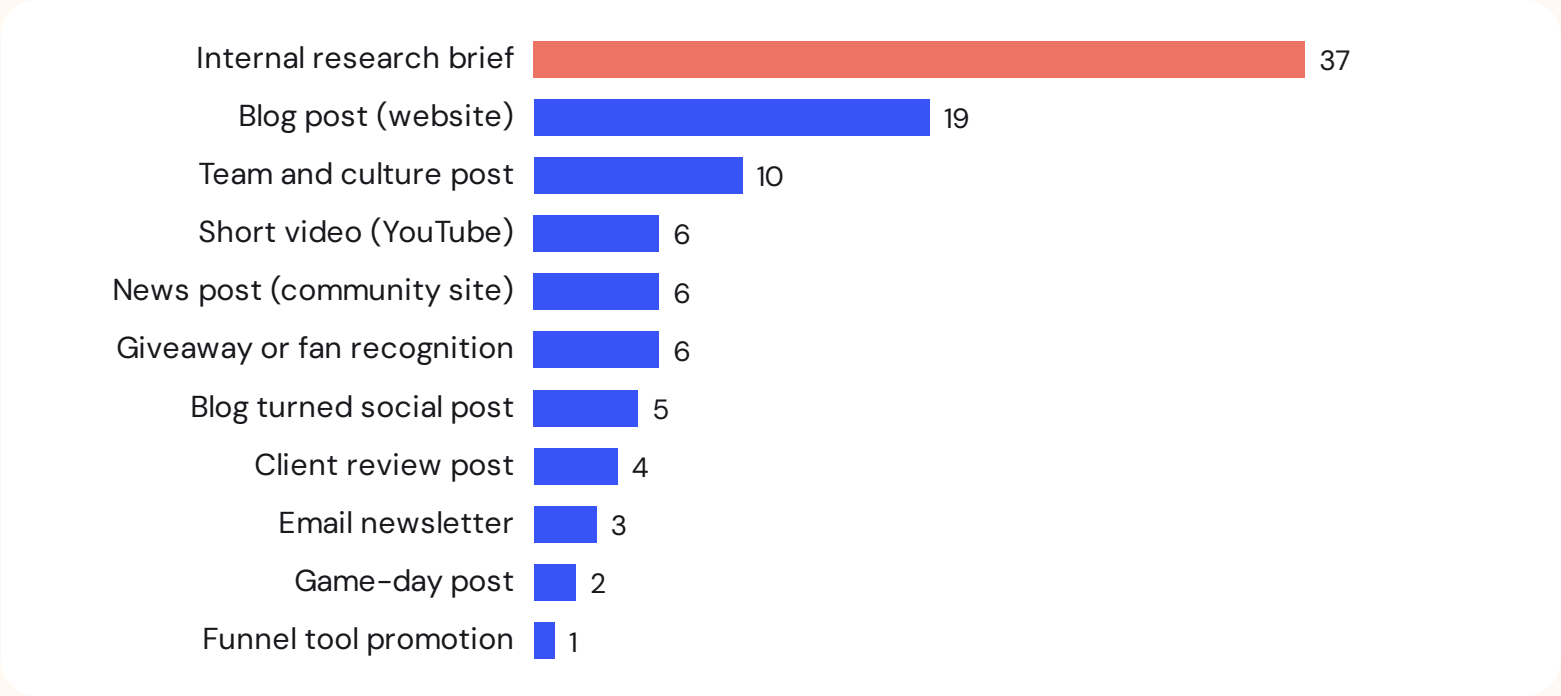
Strong first half, then a change. Most in-house posts were flagged as posted to Meta from January to July. Every September post is flagged "No". That matches the move to native Facebook posts with the link in the first comment, so September blogs reached Facebook as separate "Socials" cards rather than link posts. Update the Blog Shelf flag so it reflects native versions.

Reddit and Quora stopped in January. Nine posts from December 31 to January 24 were cross-posted to Reddit, Quora or both, and Reddit still sent 440 sessions this year. No post since has been shared there.

Vendor posts were rarely flagged for Meta (6 of 52).

What the Content Bank shipped, August to October

Figure 14 Executed Content Bank cards by type, Aug 16 to Oct 9. 99 most recent cards.



Production is research-led. Thirty-seven cards were internal briefs: the daily Southstate wreck and law watch, the PI content brief and the events tracker. They feed the blog, video and news work that follows.

The published mix follows the pillars. Blog posts and news (Next Steps and Close to Home), short explainer videos repurposed from blogs, giveaways and review posts (community), and State University game-day posts that use local teams as the setting, as the research advised.

Tagging gaps: 47 of 99 cards had no format, and Nature was blank on 63, which limits reporting by pillar or format.

Social traffic and the attribution gap

Figure 15 Organic social sessions by month.

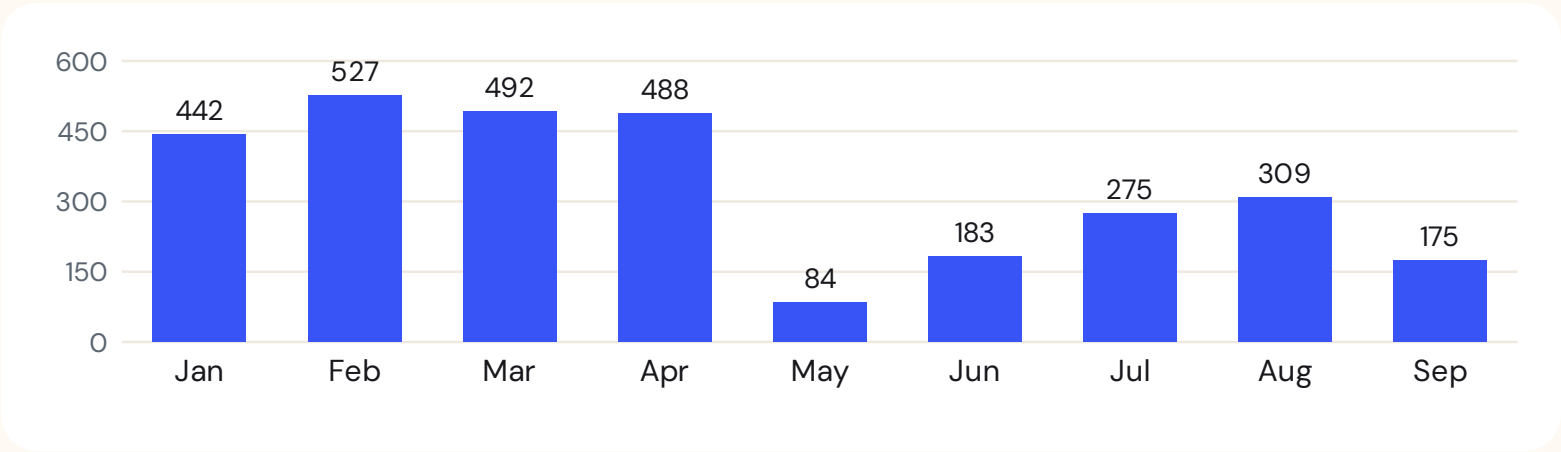
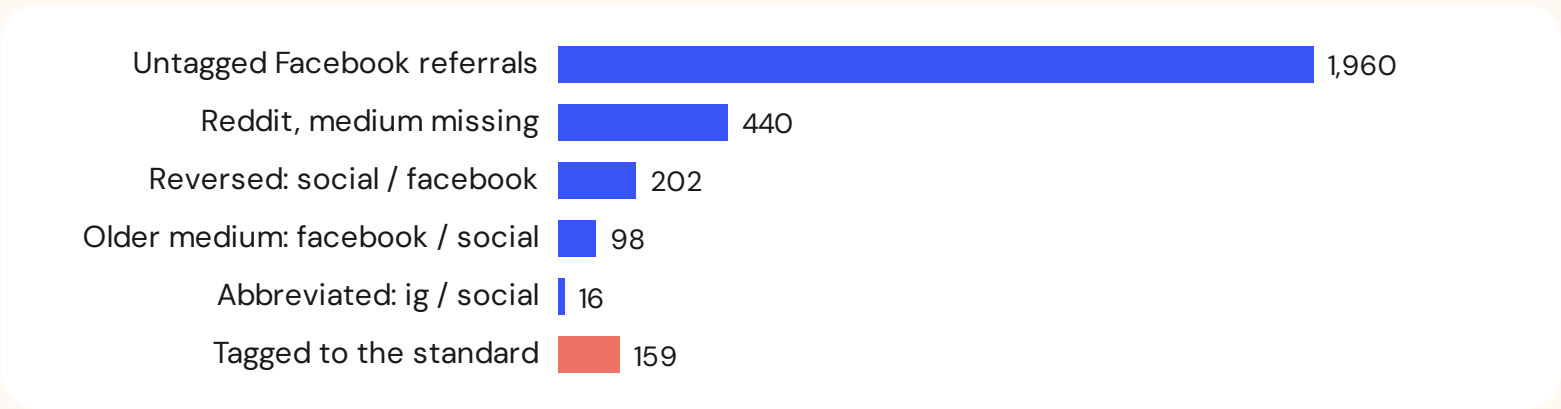


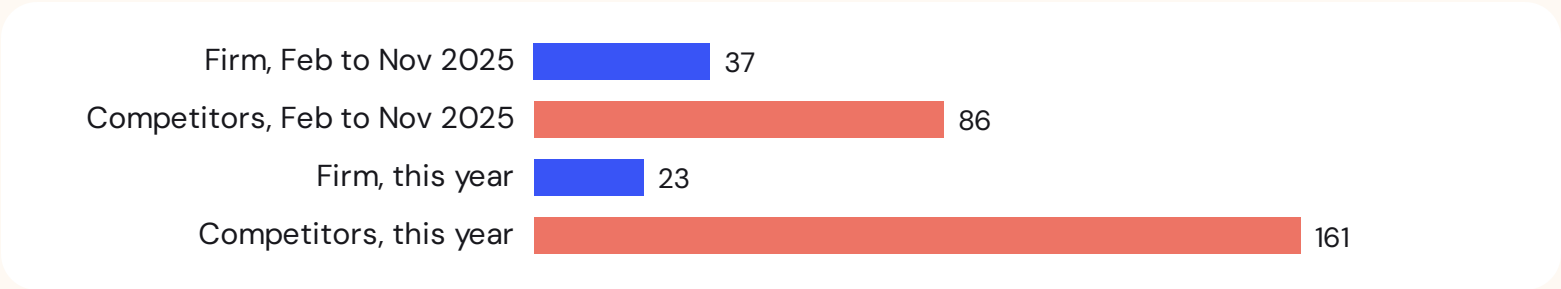
Figure 16 Social sessions by how their links were tagged, 2026.



What it shows. Organic social peaked at 527 sessions in February, fell to 84 in May and recovered to 309 in August, when key events from social reached 91 (July) and 55 (September). Of about 2,900 social sessions, 159 carried the September 4 tagging standard.

Benchmark: how the firm compares with eight Southstate firms

Figure 17 Public engagements per post: the firm against the competitor average. Blue: the firm. Coral: competitor average.



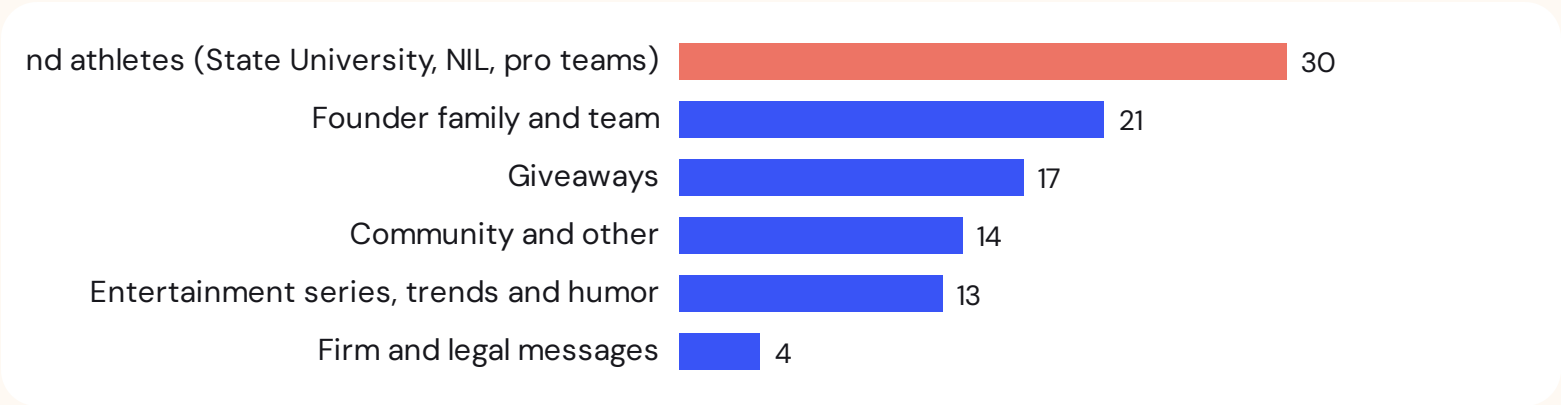
This year	Firm	Competitor average
Facebook followers and growth	5,793 (up 20%)	10,070 (up 9%)
Instagram followers and growth	812 (up 9%)	14,052 (up 60%)
Facebook posts	425	182
Facebook engagements per post	41	55
Instagram engagements per post	2.5	434

The gap is Instagram. On Facebook the firm posts more than twice as often as competitors, grows twice as fast and earns close to their engagement per post. On Instagram competitors grew 60% and earn 170 times the engagement per post.

Competitors tracked: Competitor A, Competitor B, Competitor C, Competitor D, Competitor E, Competitor F, Competitor G and Competitor H.

What wins for competitors: sports, series and giveaways

Figure 18 Competitors' 99 most-engaged posts this year, by type. Number of posts.



Competitor A dominates. Seventy-seven of the 99 top competitor posts are Competitor A's: State University athletes under NIL deals, a recurring video series (a recurring street-interview series), concert and laptop giveaways, and the founder's family. One series post drew 173,758 engagements.

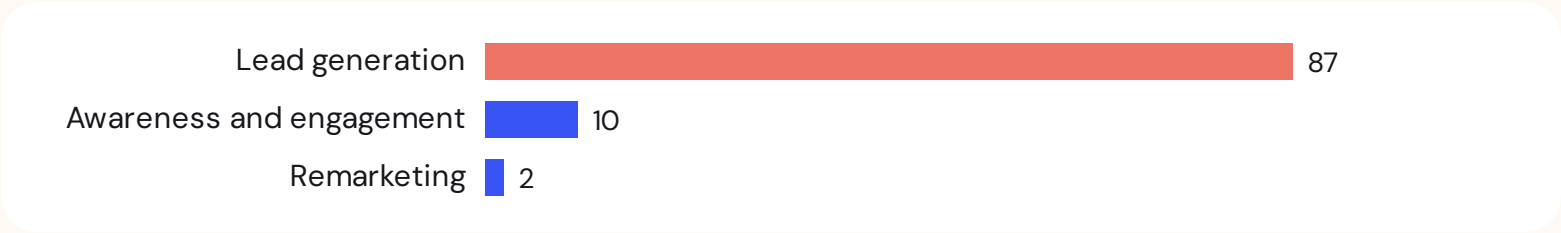
What the firm can use. Sports work for competitors as a setting: game days, athletes and fan giveaways, not legal messages. The firm's State University home-opener post drew 2,632 views, in line with the research advice to use local teams as the backdrop. A recurring, personality-led series is the format the firm does not yet have.

Competitor results are public engagements; the firm's top-post list uses views. Compare the mix, not the totals.

Paid social: the same budget, four times the conversions

Measure	Year before	This year
Spend	\$29,633	\$30,655
Impressions	5,720,710	3,379,068
Clicks	64,544	22,916
Web conversions	22	99
Cost per web conversion	\$1,347	\$310
Cost per thousand impressions	\$5.18	\$9.07

Figure 19 Web conversions by campaign goal this year. Coral: lead generation, 22% of spend.



Campaign goal	Spend	Web conversions	Cost per conversion
Lead generation (car accident, bottom of funnel)	\$6,631	87	\$76
Awareness and engagement	\$18,257	10	\$1,826
Remarketing	\$5,636	2	\$2,818

What changed. Spend moved out of the Facebook Audience Network, which bought 2.5 million low-value impressions for \$4,492 from February to November 2025, into Facebook and Instagram feeds. One campaign, Leads | BOFU | Car Accident, turned \$2,402 into 87 of the 99 conversions.

What it means. The paid program now proves the research's fifth decision: judge by actions. Shift more of the awareness budget into the lead campaign and its tested creative.



Reviews: steady five-star proof, replies to confirm

Measure	November 3, 2025 to October 9, 2026
Reviews received	71 (68 Google, 3 Facebook recommendations)
Average Google rating	4.94
Five-star reviews	67
One-star reviews	1
Replies logged in Sprout	0

What it shows. The firm earns about six reviews a month at a near-perfect rating across its Capital City and Riverside profiles. Review posts also travel on social: a five-star review post on September 28 drew 1,397 views.

One thing to check. Sprout records no replies. If the team replies directly in Google Business Profile, Sprout will not see it; if not, replying to every review, especially the one-star, is the quickest trust win available.

PART 3, WHAT WE SENT

Email and SMS

See what 23,000 emails earned, which programs drew clicks, and what list health and SMS need next.

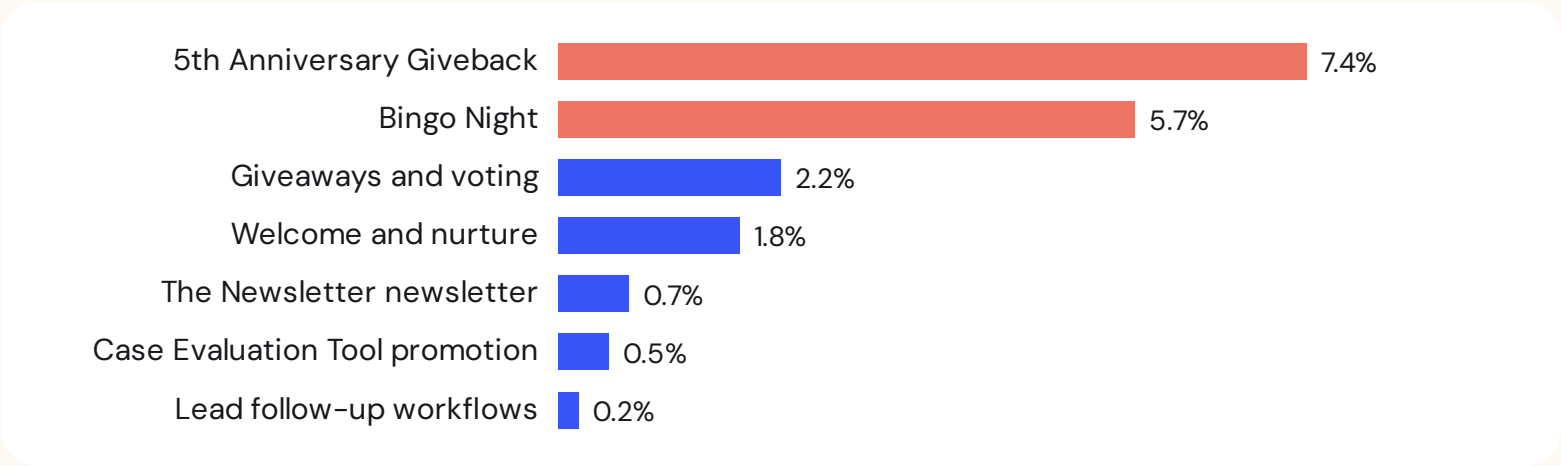
Start with [Email at a glance](#) (p. **29**). What earns clicks is in [What earns clicks](#) (p. **31**).

03

WHAT WE SENT

Email at a glance: December 31, 2025 to October 8, 2026

Figure 20 Click rate by email program. Clicks as a share of delivered emails. Coral: community and giveback programs.



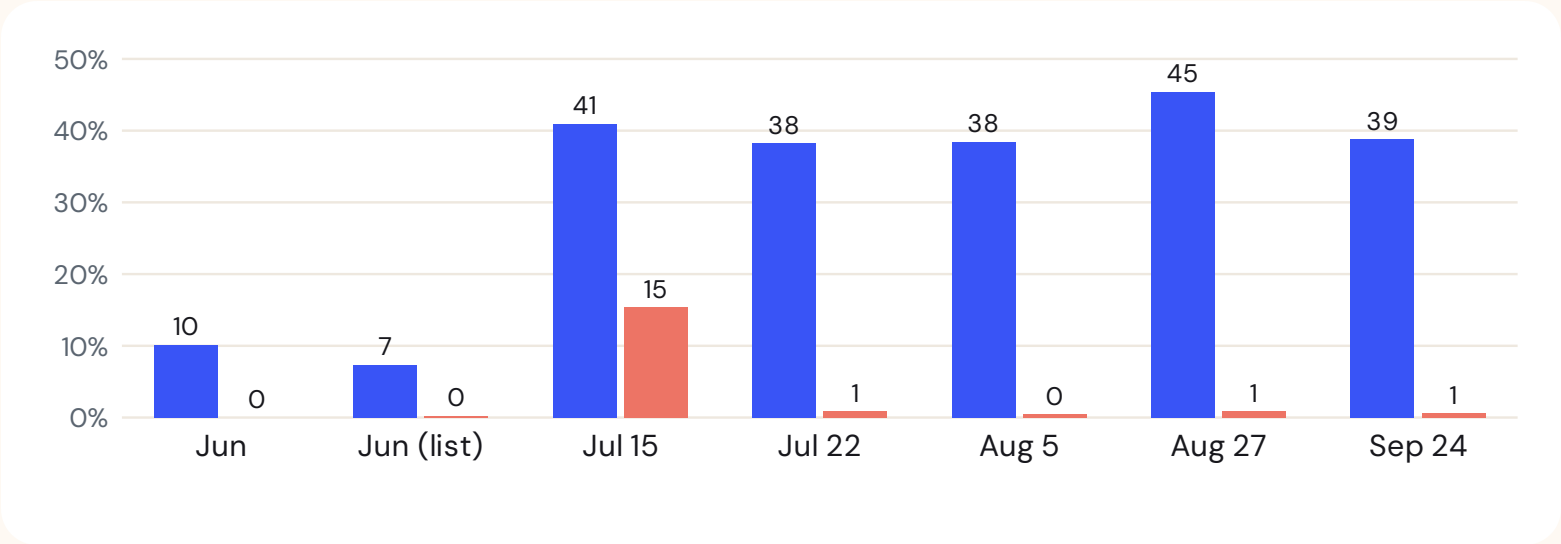
Audience email, all programs	Result
Emails sent	23,240 across 108 sends and workflow steps
Delivered	22,111 (95.1%)
Open rate	18.7%
Click rate	2.3% (508 clicks)
Unsubscribes and spam complaints	70 (0.32%) and 10
Permanent bounces	432 (1.9% of sent)

Source: GoHighLevel email statistics export, October 9, 2026. Staff-only emails (birthday shoutouts and intake alerts, 474 emails) are excluded from audience figures. Opens are inflated by mail apps that preload images, so clicks are the firmer measure.

The Newsletter: strong opens on the core list, few clicks

Figure 21 Open and click rates by newsletter send. Blue: open rate. Coral: click rate. Resends to unopened contacts excluded.

● Open rate ● Click rate



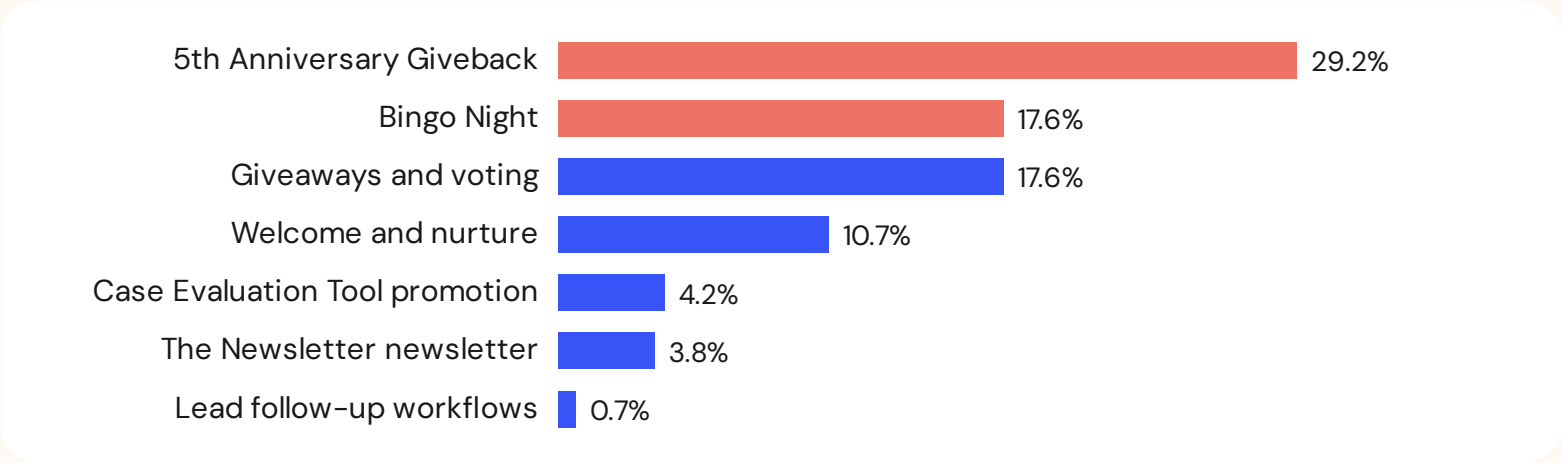
Send	Delivered	Opens	Clicks	Unsubscribes
June issue (core list)	286	29	0	1
June issue to an imported partner list	2,262	167	6	2
July, Issue 2	215	88	33	0
July, Issue 3	[area code]	86	2	1
August, Issue 4	221	85	1	0
August, Issue 6	962	437	8	8
September 24 (labeled Issue 8)	884	343	5	12

What it shows. Since July, on its own list The Newsletter opens like a well-read newsletter, 38% to 45%. Clicks are the problem: after Issue 2 (15% click rate), no issue passed 1%. The June send to an imported list of 2,262 contacts opened at 7% and drew six clicks.

Issues 5 and 7 do not appear in the export, and the September 24 send carries an August label. Confirm the sending record against the Asana issue log.

What earns clicks: community over answers

Figure 22 Click-to-open rate by program. Of people who opened, the share who clicked. Coral: community and giveback programs.



Community wins the click. People who opened a Bingo Night or 5th Anniversary Giveback email clicked 18% to 29% of the time. People who opened The Newsletter or the Case Evaluation Tool launch clicked about 4% of the time.

Answers earn the open, not the click. The Newsletter's Next Steps sections are read, but readers rarely leave the email for more. The Case Evaluation Tool launch reached 3,110 inboxes and drew 15 clicks, then 9 more from a resend.

Lead follow-ups are a dead end. Thirty follow-up emails to people who filled in a form were opened 30% of the time and clicked once. They need one clear next step, such as the case-evaluation button or the chat widget.

List health: growth, bounces, failures and resends

Issue	What happened	Why it matters
A failed welcome send	On May 29 the community welcome email reached 420 of 1,155 contacts; 358 failed outright	A sending-domain or platform failure at scale; check it before the next large import
Old lists bounce	The a local best-of award vote email bounced 74 of 536 (14%); the June newsletter to an imported list bounced 66	Bounces above 2% hurt every later send; remove hard bounces after each campaign
Imported lists stay cold	an imported partner list opened at 7%, then 2% on the resend	Welcome imported contacts with one high-value email before adding them to The Newsletter
Resends add opens, not action	Six resends to unopened contacts drew 441 opens and 16 clicks, with twice the complaint rate of first sends	Keep resends for time-sensitive events only
Unsubscribes grew with the list	The September 24 newsletter lost 12 subscribers (1.4%) after the list grew from about 220 to about 960	Expected after a list expansion; watch whether it settles

Permanent bounces across all audience email: 432 (1.9% of sent). Spam complaints: 10.

Workflows, tracking and SMS

Workflow	Delivered	Open rate	Click rate
5th Anniversary Giveback registration journey	1,400	44%	18%
Bingo Night pre-registration and registration journeys	463	38%	8%
Case Evaluation Tool drip, emails 1 and 2	804	17%	1.0%
Car accident ad and website form follow-ups	514	30%	0.2%
community welcome and quizzes	553	17%	1.8%
Former client birthday and gift card notes	46	67%	2.2%

Tracking. GoHighLevel counted 508 audience clicks in 2026; GA4 recorded 335 email visits. Part of the gap is clicks to Facebook and registration pages, but no visit carried The Newsletter's reserved "newsletter" tag, so newsletter links are reaching the site untagged.

SMS. No SMS campaign appears in GoHighLevel or GA4 this year. It remains the one channel the research named that has not started.

Former clients. The smallest program has the best open rate (67%). Relationship notes to former clients are the most-read email the firm sends.

Email: what to do next

Move	Why
Give every newsletter issue one community hook	Community emails earn four to eight times the click-to-open rate of answer content
Put one clear action in every lead follow-up	Thirty follow-ups drew one click; add a the case-evaluation button or the chat widget button and test it
Tag every newsletter link with source newsletter	GA4 shows no newsletter-tagged visits; issue-level results are invisible on the site
Clean the list after every send	Remove hard bounces; warm imported contacts before adding them to The Newsletter
Retire routine resends	Resends added 16 clicks across 5,926 emails and doubled the complaint rate
Confirm the May 29 failure is fixed	358 failed in one send; test the sending domains before the next import
Grow former-client email and start SMS	67% open rate on relationship notes; SMS has not launched

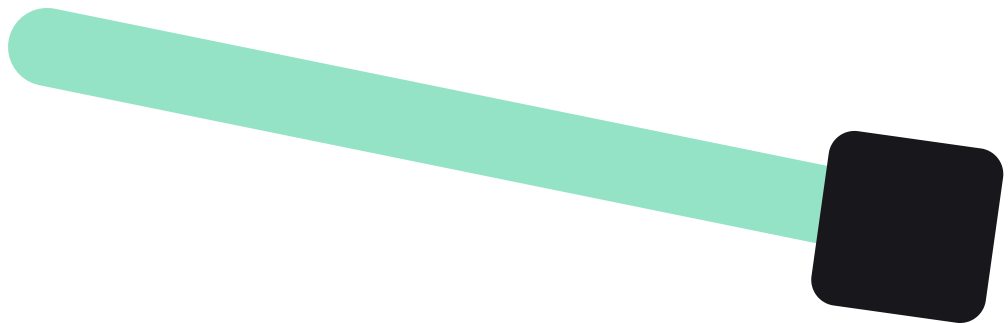
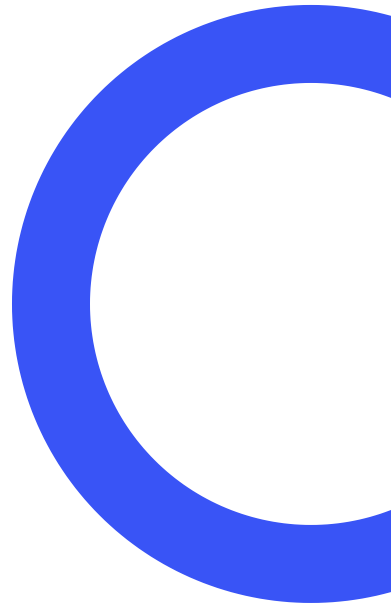
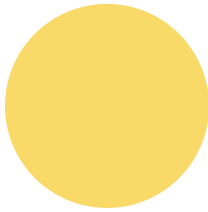
PART 4, WHAT HELD UP

The verdict

Test every claim of the first four volumes against what happened after the survey closed, and say plainly which held.

Start with [The verdict at a glance](#) (p. 37). The claims the data challenges are in [Challenged](#) (p. 39).

04



WHAT HELD UP



How the claims were tested

The question. The first four volumes made claims about this audience and turned them into direction. Eleven months of performance since the survey closed (November 3, 2025 to October 9, 2026) is enough to check most of them.

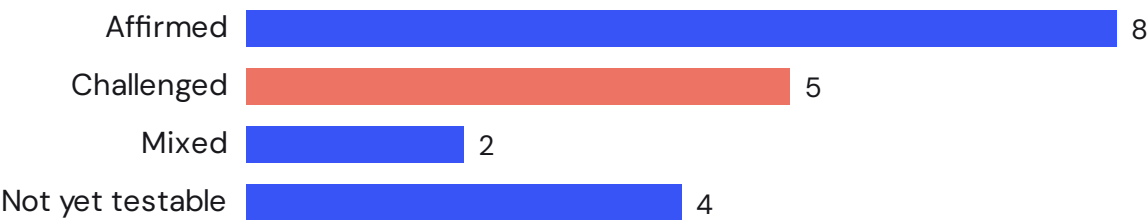
Evidence	What it can test
Sprout Social: 1,275 posts, top 100 by views, year-over-year profile metrics	Platform, content type, timing and volume claims
Sprout Social: eight competitors and their top 99 posts	Whether the market rewards what the survey advised against
Sprout Social: paid campaigns and reviews	Whether actions and reach move together
GoHighLevel: 23,240 audience emails by program	Which content earns opens and clicks by email
GA4: page traffic, engagement time and key events	Blog topics, search and conversion-path claims
Search Console: pages through GA4, and a query export with page mapping	Search visibility, intent and the money-page claims
Backlinks audit: 666 links marked keep, review or disavow	Authority behind the money pages
Asana: 136 blog posts and 99 executed cards	What was actually published under each pillar

The rule. Affirmed: the data points the way the claim predicted, on its own metric. Challenged: the data points the other way. Mixed: it holds on one metric and fails on another. Not yet testable: the firm has not done the thing the claim was about.

Metrics used are reach, views, engagement, clicks, website engagement and key events. Case outcomes are outside the scope of this verdict.

The verdict at a glance: nineteen claims

Figure 23 Claims from Volumes 01 to 04, by verdict. Coral: challenged.



Claim (volume)	Verdict
Facebook is where this audience is (01)	Affirmed
Answers first suits everyone (02, 03)	Affirmed
Local, news-style content wins (01, 03)	Affirmed
No content interest belongs to one platform (02)	Affirmed
Judge by actions, not likes (04)	Affirmed
Tests need volume; blogs are too small (04)	Affirmed
Blogs answer, commercial pages convert (03)	Affirmed
One brand signature everywhere (03)	Affirmed
Warmth, not jokes (03)	Challenged
Everyday stories as Life After a Crash (02, 03)	Challenged
Teams as backdrop; game-day only for NFL (02)	Challenged
Early morning first for timing tests (01, 02)	Challenged
Money pages win "I need a lawyer" searches (03)	Challenged
A second app adds little (01)	Mixed
Posting cadence drives reach (04)	Mixed
Streaming TV and audio (01, 03)	Not yet testable
Two viewer groups (02)	Not yet testable
Warm versus neutral delivery (04)	Not yet testable
Answer versus story, matched (04)	Not yet testable

Affirmed: what the data confirms

Claim	Evidence since the survey
Facebook is where this audience is. Survey: 85% use it.	Facebook carried 71% of social impressions and 97% of engagements; Facebook referrals sent more website visits than every other social source combined.
Answers first suits everyone.	Next Steps posts drew 56% of tracked blog views and the most social views of any type (74,431 from 8 posts). Both channels' top posts are the same answer: inspection-sticker changes. On email, answers earn opens (38% to 45% on The Newsletter's core list) but few clicks.
Local, news-style content wins. Survey: 51% read local news sites.	Close to Home blog posts beat Life After a Crash posts on median views (59 to 45); local quizzes and Bingo Night pages drew 4,970 views; the Basin Bridge post drew 7,958 social views; Bingo Night and giveback emails drew 6% to 7% click rates against under 1% for the newsletter.
No content interest belongs to one platform.	The same nine posts ran on Facebook and Instagram and drew similar views on both.
Judge by actions, not likes.	Paid impressions fell 41% and clicks 64% while web conversions rose from 22 to 99; organic engagement fell 48% while key events from organic social rose from 2 in January to 91 in July; email resends added 441 opens but only 16 clicks.
Tests need thousands of visits.	Only two 2026 blog posts passed 1,000 views; social posts reach 1,000 to 43,000. Tests belong on social and paid, on early actions.
Blogs answer; commercial pages convert.	2026 blog posts logged 6 key events; the Contact page 1,841 and the Capital City Car Accident Lawyer page 127. In search, answer posts drew 1,571 organic clicks to the money pages' 77.
One brand signature everywhere.	Brand and milestone posts have the highest median social views of any type (2,734); brand searches bring 70% of organic clicks at a 10% click rate.

Challenged: where the data disagrees

Claim	What the data shows instead
Warmth, not jokes: humor risks credibility on an injury subject.	Entertainment series and trend posts were 13 of competitors' top 99 posts but drew 67% of their engagements; one drew 173,758. The firm's own quizzes and memes sit mid-table. Humor wins attention in this market; its effect on trust is still untested.
Everyday-life stories (reality with lifestyle) are the firmest story base, delivered as Life After a Crash.	Injury-centered stories were the weakest type on both channels: lowest median blog views (45) and lowest median social views (1,251). Everyday human content did win, but as team faces and community events: 30 team posts drew 57,946 views.
Local teams are a backdrop only; keep game-day framing for NFL placements.	College sports drive the market: 30 of competitors' top 99 posts are State University, NIL or pro-team posts, and one State University game-day post drew 14,757 engagements. The firm's State University home-opener post drew 2,632 views. The backdrop idea holds; the NFL-only limit does not.
Commercial pages own "I need a lawyer" searches; posts handle the questions.	The money pages reached page one in spring and appeared 724,000 times in 2026 but drew 77 organic clicks (0.01%). Hire-a-lawyer searches are three quarters of impressions and 8% of clicks; each priority search splits across several firm URLs, and the money pages have almost no backlinks of their own.
Early morning is the first posting window to test.	Among the top 100 posts, those published 3 to 9 PM averaged about 3,900 views against about 2,000 before 9 AM, and 6 of the top 10 went out between 3 and 9 PM.

Challenged means the evidence points the other way on the claim's own metric. Each challenge becomes a test (Revised tests, p. 44).

Challenge 1 and 2: tone and stories

Figure 24 Share of competitors' top-post engagements, by content type. Percent of engagements on their 99 most-engaged posts.

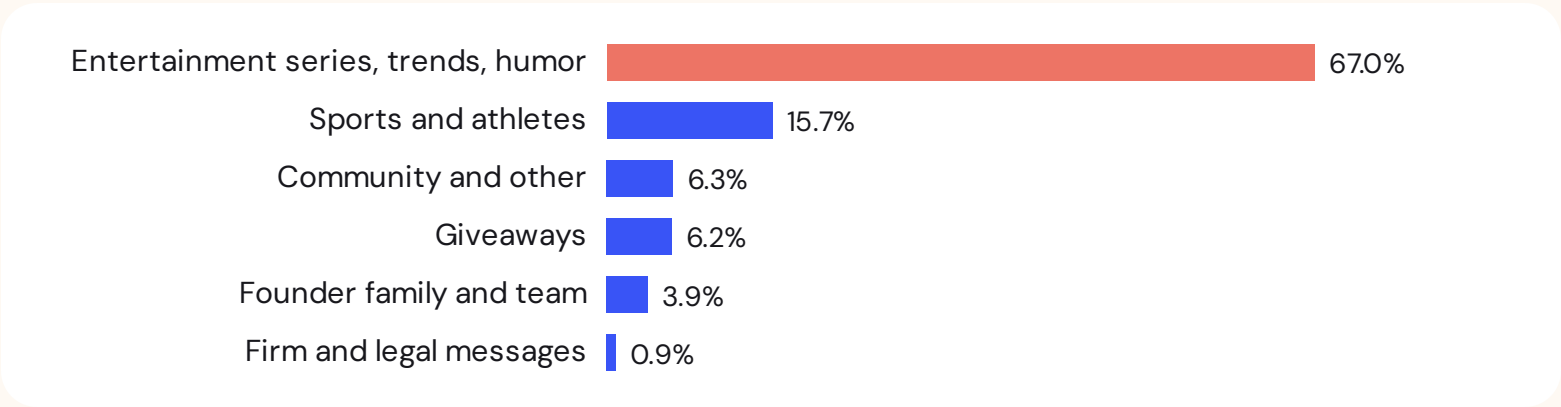
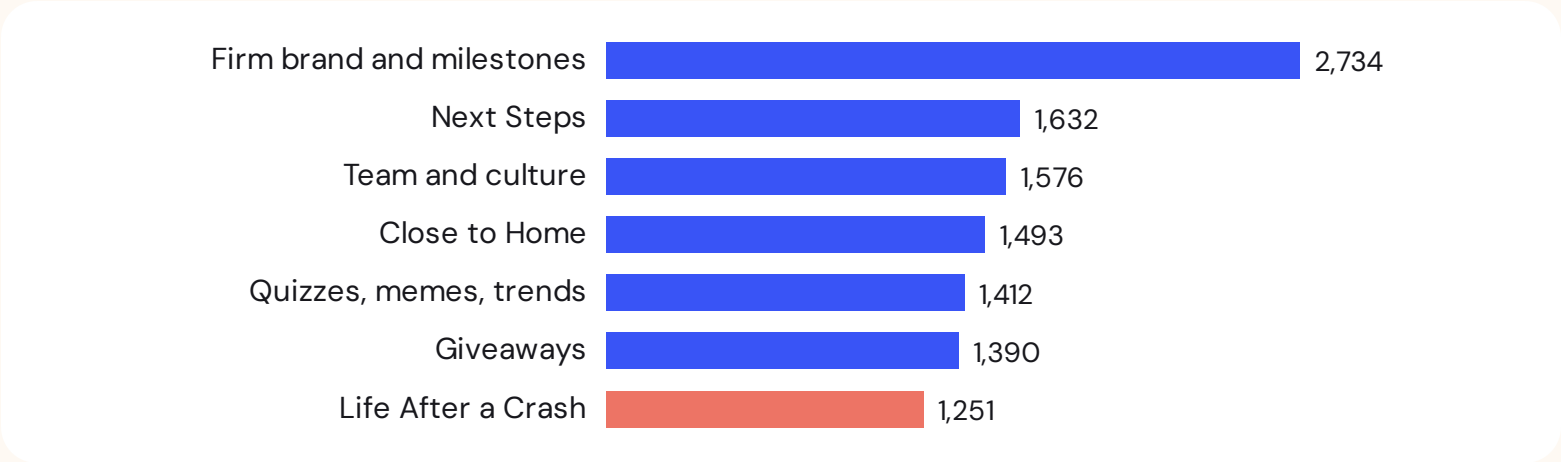


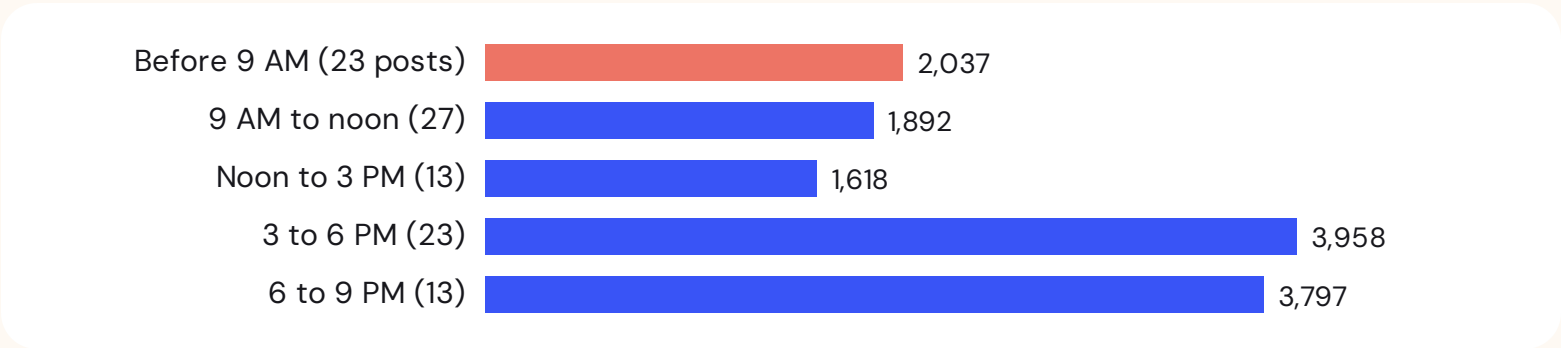
Figure 25 The firm's top 100 posts: median views by content type. Coral: the Life After a Crash pillar.



What it means. The survey found that reality and lifestyle viewers want real people. The data agrees, but the real people they watch are the firm's own team and neighbors, not crash victims. Keep Life After a Crash for reviews and consented results; move the everyday-story energy into people-first content. Humor earns reach in this market; test it before adopting it.

Challenge 3 and 4: sports and timing

Figure 26 The firm's top 100 posts: average views per post by publishing window. Coral: the survey's most common usual time.



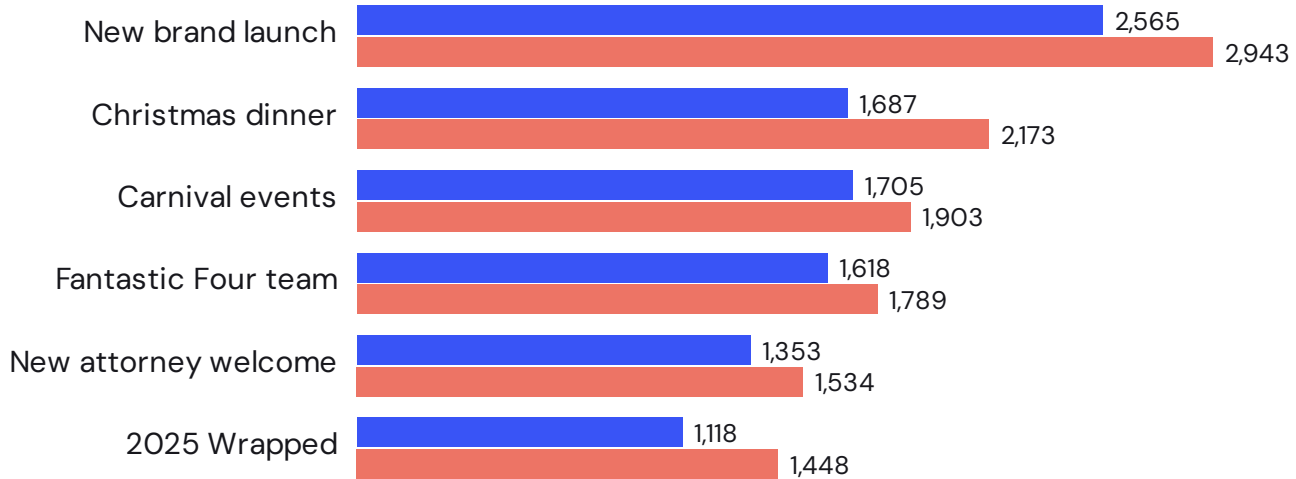
Window	Survey: usual time	Top 100: posts	Top 100: total views
Before 9 AM	40%	23	46,861
9 AM to noon	31%	27	51,095
Noon to 3 PM	20%	13	21,038
3 to 6 PM	31%	23	91,031
6 to 9 PM	28%	13	49,357

Timing. People may open their apps early, but the firm's biggest posts landed in the late afternoon and evening. The survey measured habits, not attention; the data now favors 3 to 9 PM. The top-100 list cannot show a base rate for every post, so test the windows directly.

Sports. College sports belong in the plan as a setting, with game days, local athletes and fan giveaways, keeping legal messages out of the play-by-play.

Mixed: second platforms and posting volume

Figure 27 The same post on Facebook and Instagram: views. Blue: Facebook. Coral: Instagram.



A second app adds little: mixed. For the firm it holds on engagement: Instagram earned 1,044 engagements against Facebook's 54,493. But Instagram views ran higher than Facebook on every shared post, and competitors earn 434 engagements per Instagram post against the firm's 2.5. Instagram has the audience; repurposed posts are not reaching it.

Volume drives reach: mixed. Posting fell 58% and impressions held, so impressions per post more than doubled (1,519 to 3,502). Engagement fell 48%. Fewer posts did not cost reach; they did cost interaction.

What the four volumes tell, eleven months on

The core held. The compendium's spine is affirmed: this is a Facebook audience that wants practical, local answers, and success should be judged by actions rather than likes. Every channel's best performer was an answer about a Southstate rule that touches every driver.

The emotional layer needs revising. Volume 02 found a real appetite for everyday human content, and Volume 03 turned it into crash stories and a cautious tone. The market says the appetite is real but wants familiar faces, local pride, humor and sport. The survey measured what people watch; it could not measure what they share.

Revise	From	To
Life After a Crash	Injury-centered everyday stories	People first: team faces and community, with consented client results
Tone	Warmth, not jokes	Warmth by default, with a tested, compliant humor or series format
Sports	Backdrop only; game-day only for NFL	College game days and local athletes as the setting
Second platform	A second chance at the same people	Instagram as its own test with native reels
Timing	Test early morning first	Test 3 to 9 PM against early morning
Search	Commercial pages own commercial searches	One front door per money search, backlinks to the money pages, a cleaned link profile, and brand demand built by social and community

Revised tests: what to settle next

Test	Compare	Measure
Tone	A recurring, compliant local series or trend post against a warm answer post	Engagements and shares per post, link clicks, website key events
People first	A team or community post against an injury story on the same theme	Views, engagement rate, profile visits
College game day	State University game-day setting with a Next Steps tip against the same tip without it	Reach, engagements, follower growth
Instagram native	A native reel against the repurposed Facebook post	Instagram engagements per post (goal: past 25), follower growth
Posting window	3 to 9 PM against before 9 AM, rotated weekly on matched posts	Impressions and engagements per post
Paid mix	Lead-campaign share of spend from 22% to 50%	Cost per web conversion, web conversions
Money-page snippet	Rewritten title and description on one money page, before against after	Organic clicks per 100,000 impressions

Still to run from Volume 04. The matched answer-versus-story test and the warm-versus-neutral delivery test were never run, and streaming TV and audio were never bought. Those claims stay open until they are.

Data still needed, and how this entry was built

Still needed	Why
Search Console queries and pages	Explain the mid-year organic dip and blog rankings

How posts were assigned to pillars. Firm news when the title names an award, ranking or office. Close to Home for community-site posts, local events and guides, and local road news. Life After a Crash for injury, recovery, family and wrongful-death topics. Next Steps for everything else. Local place means the title or keywords name Capital City, Riverside County, Riverside, a Southstate interstate or a named county or city.

Data notes. GA4 figures cover January 1 to October 9, 2026 for the firm's property and include community-site pages. Blog Shelf counts run to September 30. The Content Bank sample is the 99 most recent executed cards. Search Console query figures cover April 24, 2025 to August 24, 2026; about 5% of clicks come from outside the country, likely the firm's own team. Social figures come from Sprout Social; year-before values for link clicks and video views are derived from Sprout's percentage changes. Top-post types were assigned from each post's text.

Prepared October 10, 2026. Reference owner: Digital Advocacy Strategist.